

CASE STUDY

They rolled it out to save time. It kept guessing Wrong.

They asked us to roll out Microsoft 365 Copilot so the team could save time on emails and documents. The scope: speed was never the issue — the firm's knowledge was scattered and ungoverned, so Copilot grounded on the wrong sources and answered confidently from them

Real Problem

“Roll out Microsoft 365 Copilot so the team saves time on emails and documents..”

Scope

Typing speed wasn't the bottleneck. Knowledge was scattered across drives and sites with messy permissions, so Copilot grounded on the wrong data — fast answers no one could trust.

01. The Situation

A professional-services firm — a mid-sized legal and advisory practice — bought Microsoft 365 Copilot expecting an instant productivity lift. Instead, lawyers and consultants got fluent, plausible answers drawn from outdated templates, superseded matters and the wrong client folders. The model was working exactly as designed; the knowledge underneath it simply wasn't ready to be trusted.

02. What We Found

Our diagnostic surfaced three compounding issues.

- 1. **Knowledge scattered, not governed.** Current and obsolete versions sat side by side across SharePoint, OneDrive and email — Copilot couldn't tell which to trust.
- 2. **Permissions were a mess.** Over-broad SharePoint permissions meant Copilot could surface — and pull from — things people shouldn't see.
- 3. **No grounding, no adoption.** Without governed sources or trained prompts, people tried Copilot once, got a wrong answer, and quietly stopped.

~20%

Knowledge workers spend about a fifth of the week — roughly 1.8 hours a day — searching for and gathering information. Copilot can give that time back, but only on a foundation it can trust. So we didn't start with prompts. We started by making the knowledge trustworthy.

M C K I N S E Y G L O B A L I N S T I T U T E

03. What We Did

Make the knowledge trustworthy first — then accelerate.

Govern the data first

Intake and admissions rebuilt as a PowerApps form —the paperless ask, delivered on day one, and the source of clean, instant data.

Ground it, target the work

We grounded Microsoft 365 Copilot on those trustworthy sources and built the highest value use-cases—proposals and RFPs, client and matter summaries—with a tested prompt library.

Automate assignment

A structured Copilot adoption program — training, prompt patterns and champions — turned a tool people had abandoned into one they rely on.

A NOTE ON SCOPE

We did not replace the patient-admin system or the electronic health record. PowerPlatform sat on top as the coordination and visibility layer, integrated with the systemsofrecord —anyengagement claiming otherwise is one to walk away from.

04. How We Rolled It Out

We didn't boil the ocean. We piloted with one practice group, proved the hours saved and the quality lift, then scaled — keeping fee-earners in the build so the use-cases matched real work. The fastest way to kill an AI rollout is to let people meet a wrong answer first; we made the foundation trustworthy before we asked anyone to rely on it.

05. What An Engagement Like This Delivers

We started with a margin diagnostic across all three channels to quantify where money was escaping. Only then did we build.

~5hrs

Per person, per week

Reclaimed from drafting and searching.

~0.5d

Faster proposals & RFPs

Grounded Copilot drafts from the firm's best material.

~50%

Less time hunting for docs

Governed sources and search that actually works.

The win wasn't faster typing.It was knowledge people could finally find — and trust.

Bring us the problem

No proposal until we understand the problem.